

ID: SOMA-C-P14

Duration: 10m 00s (713 words)

Script Content:

[Practice]

When you're ready, let's begin this practice.

For this session, we will complete a seating area analysis. You will evaluate your physical environment to understand how your space is set up.

Find your usual seated position — this could be at a table, on a couch, on your bed, on the floor, or anywhere you typically spend time sitting. Sit as you normally would when eating, reading, or doing activities.

Your goal is to measure and classify the features around you. We will examine what you're sitting on, surfaces near you, lighting conditions, and how items are organized in your area.

[Short Pause] (10s - Baseline Positioning)

Start by examining what you're sitting on right now. Identify the type of seating: chair, stool, bench, couch, bed, floor with a cushion, or floor without a cushion.

Estimate how high you are from the floor. Use your hand as a measuring tool. If you're on a chair or couch, is the seat about two hand-widths high? Three hand-widths? Four or more? If you're on the floor, you're at zero hand-widths.

[Long Pause] (20s - Height Calculation)

Look around for any flat surfaces near where you're sitting. This might be a table, desk, counter, nightstand, coffee table, or even just the floor beside you.

If you have a surface nearby, estimate how high it is from the floor using hand-widths. Extend your arm toward it. Can you reach it easily, or would you need to lean forward or stand up?

Evaluate the density of objects versus empty space. Is it large enough for multiple items — books, cups, phones, papers? Or is it small with room for just one or two things? Identify what material it's made of: wood, metal, plastic, glass, or something else.

[Short Pause] (Surface Scan - 10s)

Identify the items you use regularly when sitting in this spot. This could include a phone, book, magazine, remote control, cup, food, writing materials, or anything else you interact with.

If any of these items are nearby right now, count how many you can see from where you're sitting. Estimate the size of the item you use most often. Is it approximately the size of your palm? Larger than your hand? Smaller than your hand?

Check the distance to this item. Is it within arm's reach right now, or would you need to stretch or stand to get it?

Search for storage features nearby, like drawers, shelves, or baskets. Count how many are available. Determine if these units are currently open or closed.

[Long Pause] (Item Inventory - 20s)

Shift focus to lighting in your area. Identify all light sources you can see from where you're sitting. Count them: ceiling lights, lamps, window light, or light from devices.

Determine which one provides the most light to your area right now. Classify current lighting as dim, moderate, or bright.

Check if the light creates any glare or reflections on surfaces near you that make it harder to see things clearly.

Determine the light color. Does the light look warm and yellowish, neutral white, or cool and bluish?

[Short Pause] (Lighting Check - 10s)

Examine items within arm's reach from where you're sitting.

Now, perform a systematic inventory of your immediate reach. Count every single object you can touch without standing up from your seat. Tally everything: your phone, books, cups, pens, remote controls, or even small decorative items.

Once you have your total count, sort these items into groups based on their use. Place them into three categories: Work and Media, Food and Drink, or Decoration. Ensure that every item you counted fits into one of these three groups.

Finally, assess the density of your seating area. Look at the surfaces around you and judge how much space is taken up by objects. Classify the area using one of three labels: Is the space Mostly Full, is it Half-Full, or is it Mostly Clear?

Check if the items you use most often are easy to reach or if you frequently need to stretch or stand to get them.

[Short Pause - Object Categorization] (10s)

Perform a final assessment of your seating area. Identify any obstacles near your feet or legs that limit how you can position yourself. Check for cords or cables near your seating area. Count how many you can see.

[Long Pause] (30s - Final Evaluation)

Your seating area assessment is complete. You evaluated what you're sitting on, surfaces near you, items you use, lighting, organization, and spatial setup.

[Pause] (20s - Final integration)

The assessment is finished.

Thank you for your practice.

Footer: License: Licensed under CC BY-NC-SA 4.0 (Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike). This material is part of the SOMA Architecture and is free for non-commercial research use; any adaptations must be shared under identical terms. **How to Cite:** For the most current citation, DOI, and project updates, please visit the SOMA OSF Repository (<https://osf.io/2kfvz>). **Version 1.0 (March 2026)** – Practice P14: Seating Area Analysis.